

Biblioteca

User Guide

Program version: 1.9.21

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Contents

1. Introduction
2. Installing
3. The first time: choosing the folder
4. The home screen and the language
5. Adding a book
6. Searching and filtering
7. The book record
8. Countries
9. Sync
10. From nothing to finding your first book
11. Troubleshooting
12. Glossary
13. References

Introduction

What the program does

Biblioteca is the catalogue of your books on the iPhone. It keeps the title, authors, subjects, year, country, where the copy is, whether it is on loan and your own notes — and shows all of it in a list you can search and filter.

It is the same catalogue as the Mac, Windows and Android apps: all four read and write the SAME file, biblioteca.txt. What you add on the iPhone shows up on the Mac, and the other way round.

On the iPhone it has something the others do not: the camera. You can point it at the barcode on the back cover and the book is added for you, with title, authors and year looked up from the ISBN.

What it needs

A file called biblioteca.txt, in an iCloud Drive folder called Biblioteca. That is what the app reads, and what it writes to.

If you do not have that file yet, there is nothing to create: add the first book and the app writes it.

Looking a book up by ISBN and fetching covers need the internet. Everything else works offline.

What it produces

biblioteca.txt itself, updated. It is a plain text file, one book per line with tab-separated fields — you can open it in any editor, and it does not depend on this app to be read.

Cover photos sit beside it, in the same folder.

The Countries screen also gives you a count of books by country of origin.

Installing

The iPhone app installs from the App Store, like any other. After installing there is ONE step you cannot skip: pointing the app at the iCloud folder where your biblioteca.txt lives. Without it the app opens empty.

Installing from the App Store

The app is free and runs on an iPhone with iOS 17 or newer.

1. Open this address on the iPhone itself: https://apps.apple.com/app/biblioteca-pessoal/id6799312712
2. Tap Get and confirm with Face ID, Touch ID or your password.
3. Wait for the download to finish and tap Open.
4. The first time it opens, the app asks for camera access. Answer Allow if you intend to scan barcodes; if you refuse, everything else still works and you can change your mind later in Settings.

Pointing it at the iCloud folder

This is the step that connects the app to your catalogue. Note that what you pick is the FOLDER, not the file — the app needs the folder so it can write cover photos beside the text.

1. On the Mac, put biblioteca.txt inside a folder called Biblioteca, in iCloud Drive.
2. On the iPhone, open the app and tap "Choose folder", on the home screen.
3. Browse to iCloud Drive, select the Biblioteca folder and confirm. Do not go inside the folder to pick the file: stop at the folder.

Checking that it worked

Go back to the home screen. Just below the app name you should see how many books were loaded — for example, 96 books loaded. If it says zero, or if the Selected field under Sync is empty, the folder was not linked: do "Choose folder" again and check that you stopped AT the Biblioteca folder, not inside it.

The first time: choosing the folder

Your books live in a text file called `biblioteca.txt`. You do not have to create it anywhere: just tell the app which folder it is in — or which folder you want it to live in. That is what the "Choose folder" button does, and it is the same one on all four platforms.

It is a row on the home screen, just above Sync. While no folder has been picked it is the only thing you can do: Add a book, Countries and Search stay dimmed, because with no file there is nowhere to write the book.

Step by step

1. On the home screen, tap "Choose folder".
2. The iPhone's file picker opens. Go to the folder where your biblioteca.txt is — or where you want it to live; if it does not exist yet, create it right there. Tap "Open".
3. The app looks at the folder and tells you what it found. There are four possible answers, and in all of them you end up ready to add books.

What the app answers

The folder already had a library

It says how many books it found and asks whether that is the one. The count is there on purpose: accepting a file without knowing what is inside it would be a guess.

The folder was empty

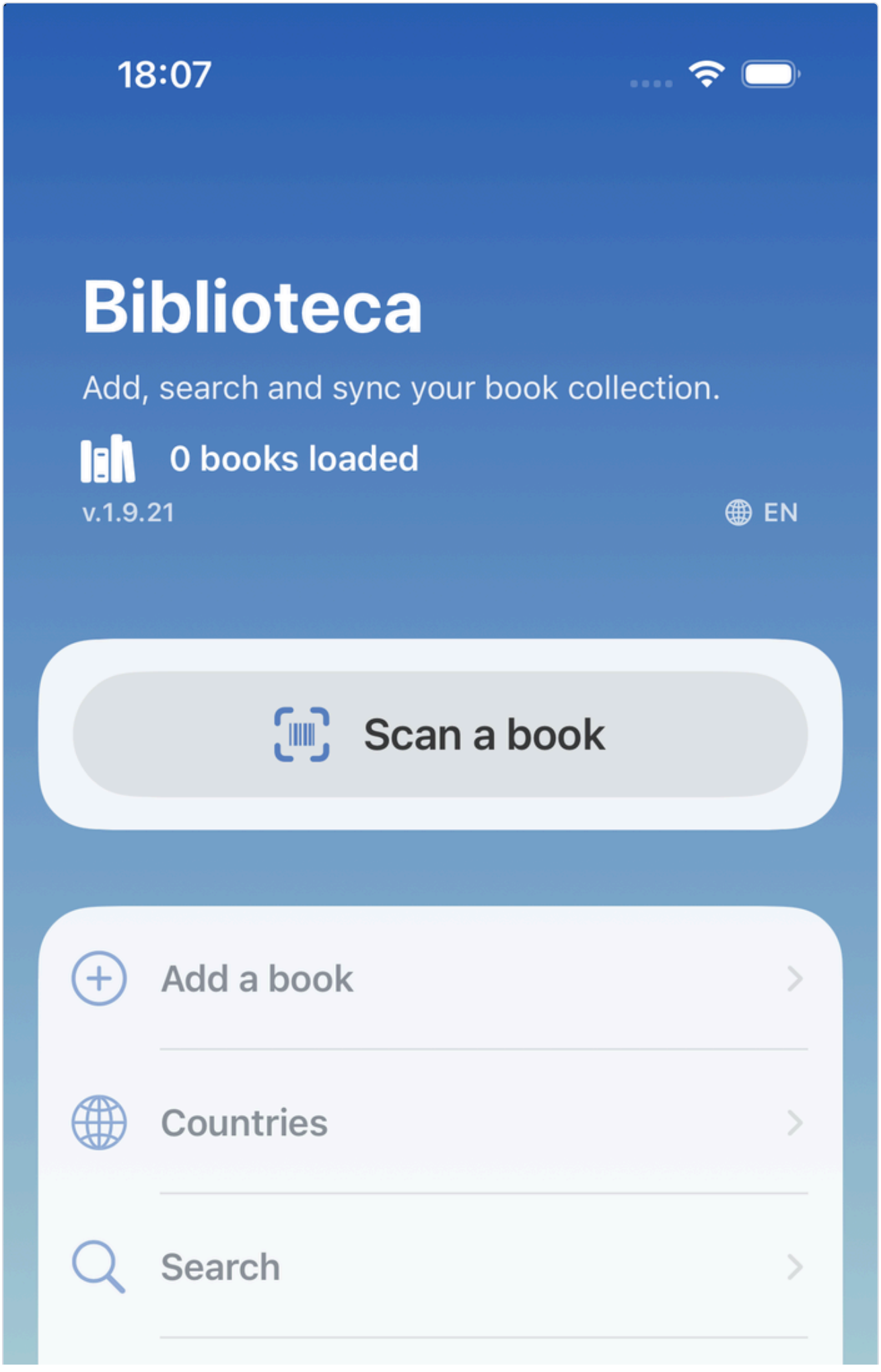
It creates biblioteca.txt there and tells you. It asks nothing — you have just picked that folder for exactly this.

There is a file and it could not be read

It says what happened and offers another folder. It never writes over it: that may be somebody's library, or a file still coming down from the cloud.

You changed folders with books already open

If the new folder is empty, it asks what to do with the books in view: move them there, or start a new, empty library. Either way, the library in the old folder is left untouched.


18:07
Biblioteca
Add, search and sync your book collection.
0 books loaded
v.1.9.21
EN
Scan a book
Add a book
Countries
Search

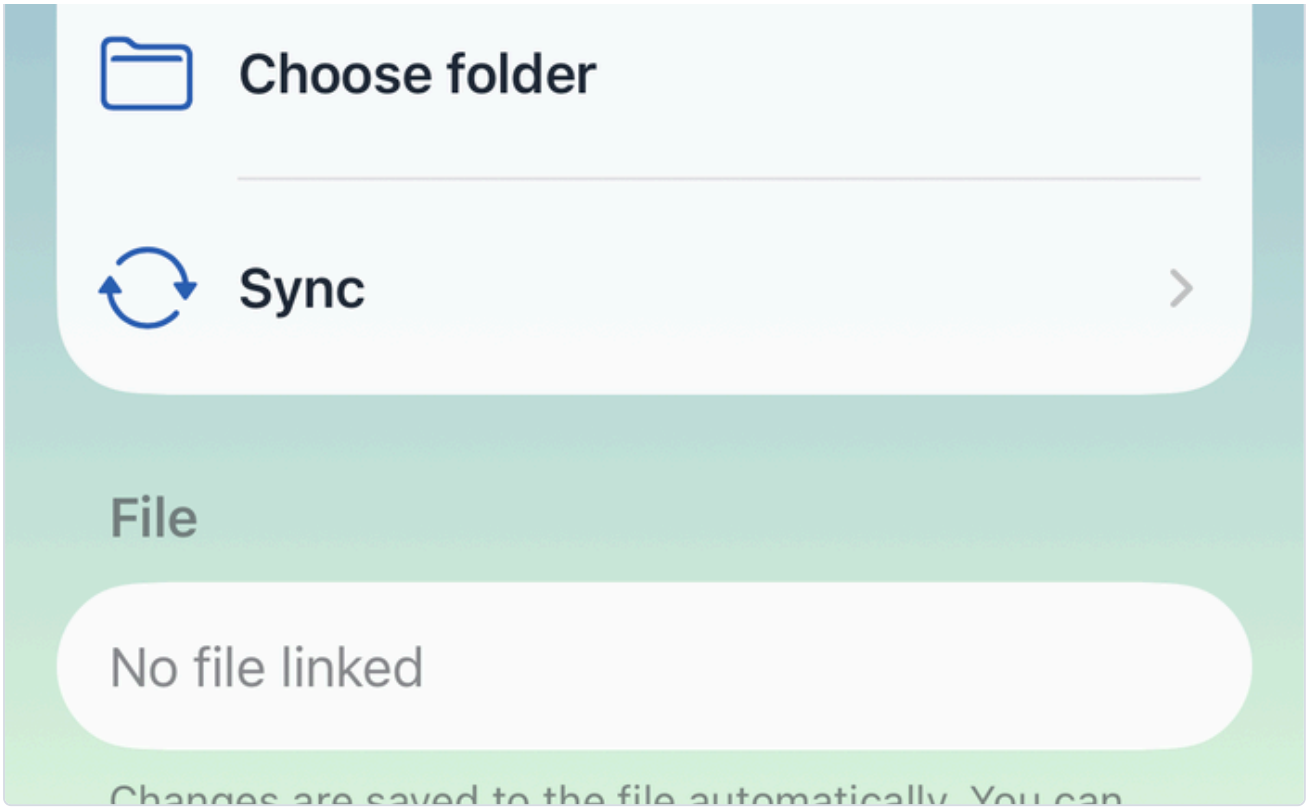


Figure 1: The home screen on the first run: only "Choose folder" responds

Examples

- Pick the Biblioteca folder inside iCloud Drive if you want the Mac to see the same collection. That is the folder the Mac app uses by default.
- Changing folders later is the same button. It is not only for the first time.
- What about biblioteca.dat, the one with the covers? It is not born with it. It only comes into being once you have covers and publish them. Until then nothing is missing: the app works without it.

The home screen and the language

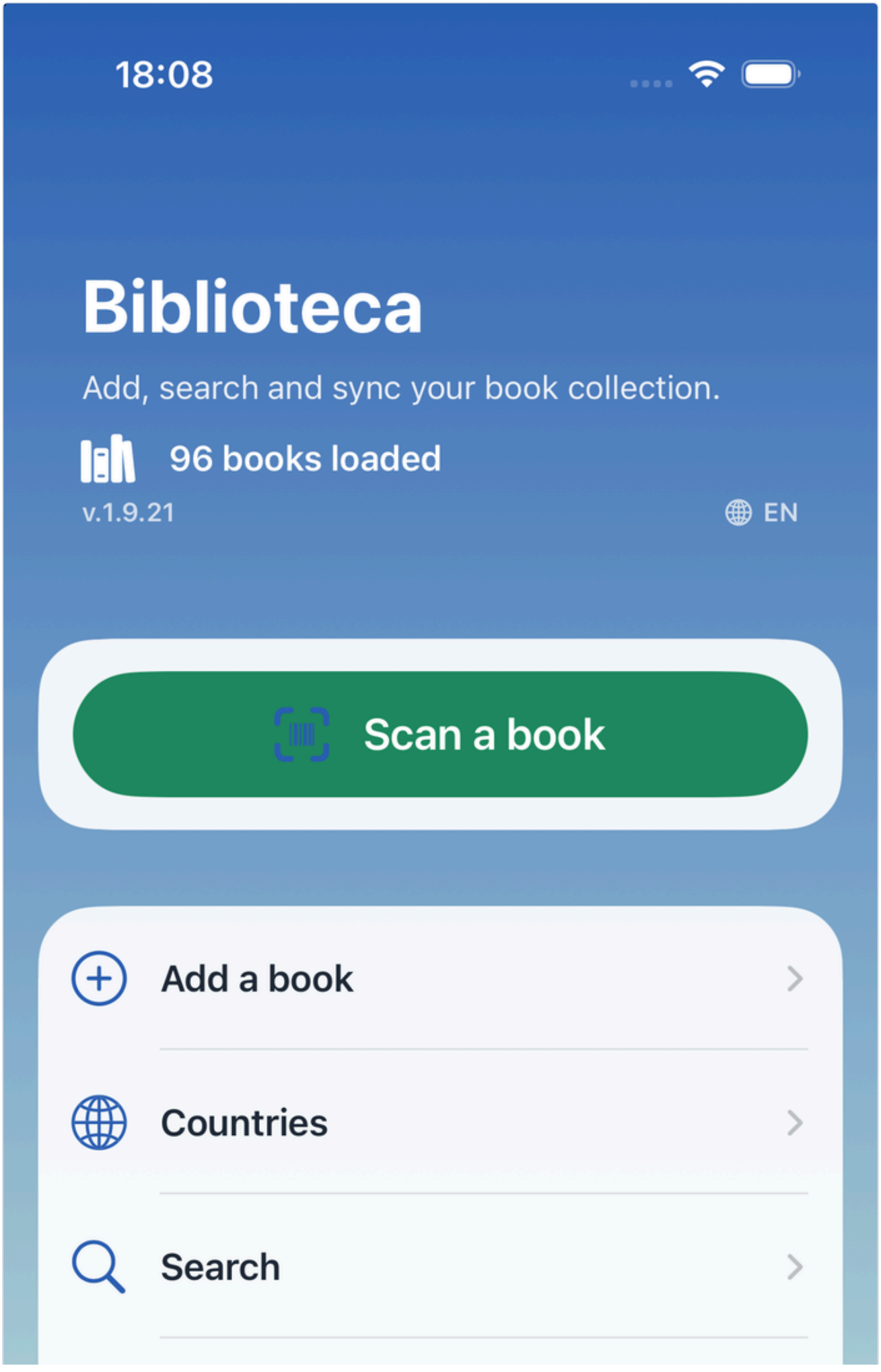
The home screen is the centre of the app: the five paths start here — scan, add, countries, search and sync — and it is where you see, at a glance, whether the catalogue loaded.

At the top are the app name, a line saying what it does, and the book count. Just below, on the left, the installed version; on the right, the language selector, marked with a globe and the letters PT or EN.

Lower down, the File section shows which file is in use, in which folder, and how many books came from it.

Step by step

1. To change the language, tap the PT/EN globe and pick Português or English.
2. The change takes effect at once, on every screen, and is remembered the next time you open the app.
3. The first time, the app chooses for you: Portuguese if the iPhone is in Portuguese, English in every other case.


18:08
Biblioteca
Add, search and sync your book collection.
96 books loaded
v.1.9.21
EN
Scan a book
Add a book
Countries
Search

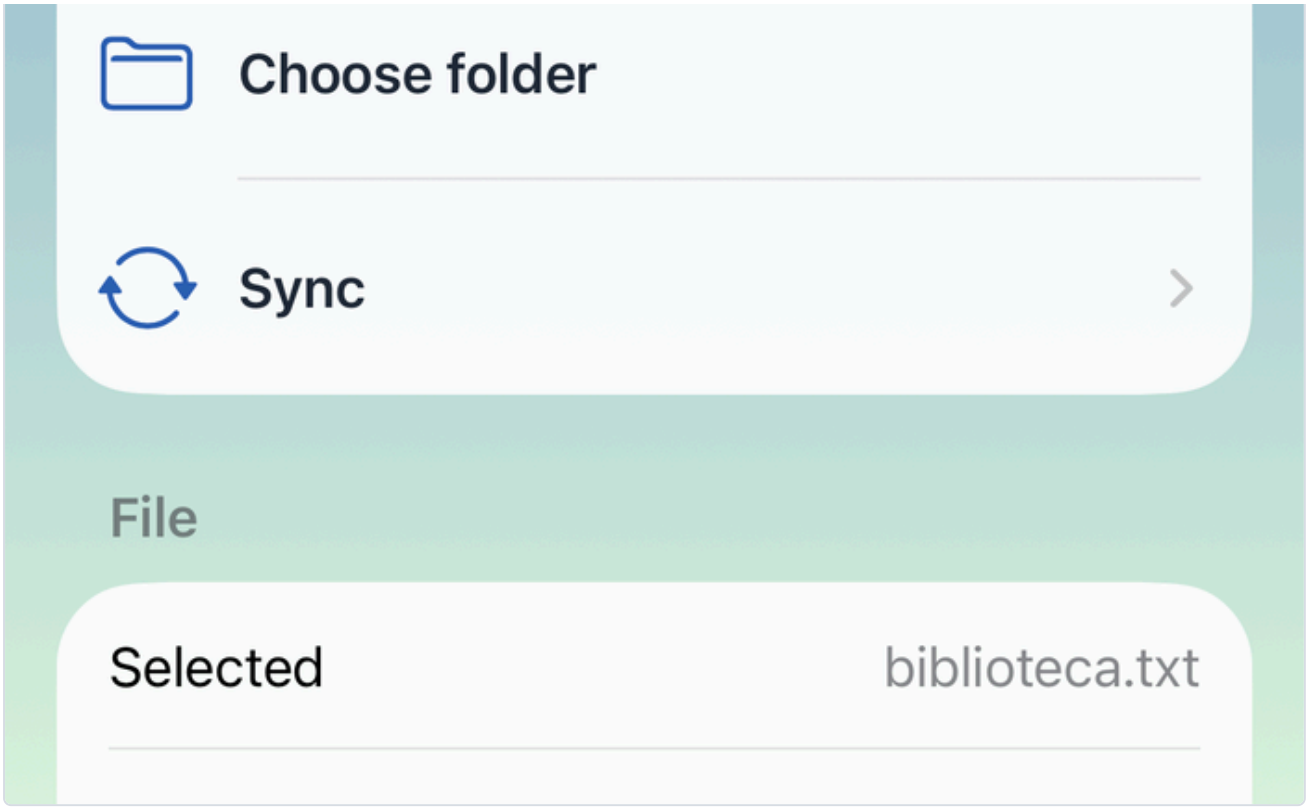


Figure 2: The home screen, with the language selector in the corner and the number of books loaded.

Examples

- 96 books loaded — the catalogue was read and the folder is linked.
- 0 books, or no count at all — the folder has not been chosen yet; go to Sync.

Adding a book

There are two ways to put a book in the catalogue, and both end on this same screen.

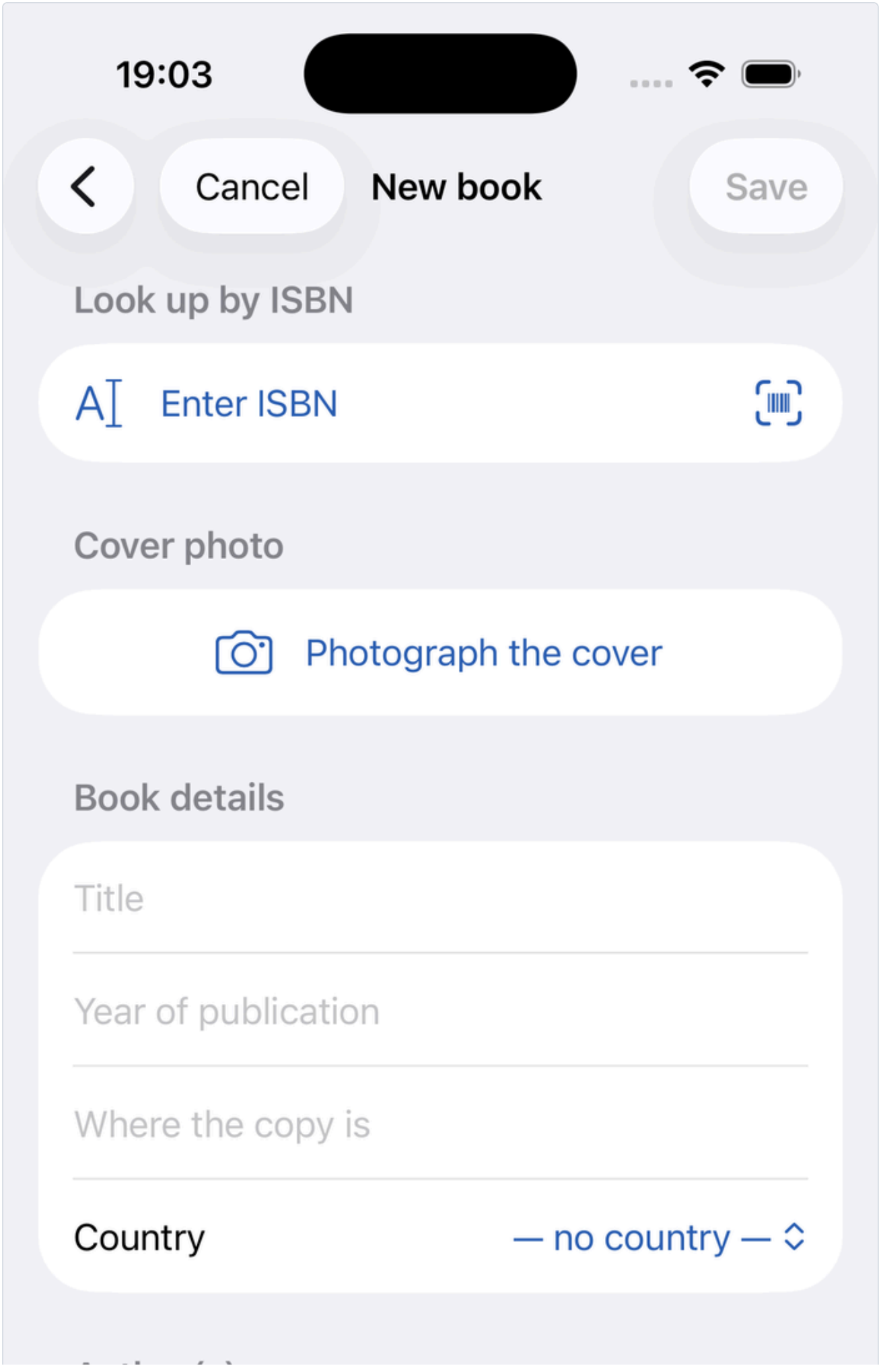
The quick one is the barcode: on the home screen, tap Scan a book and point the camera at the back cover. The app reads the ISBN, looks the book up online and opens the form already filled in with title, authors and year — you just check it and save.

The manual one is to tap Add a book and type. If you know the ISBN but do not have the book in your hands, you can type it in the field at the top and use the same lookup.

No field other than the title is required. Authors and subjects accept several: each tap on Add opens one more line.

Step by step

1. On the home screen, tap Add a book.
2. To look up by ISBN, type the 10 or 13 digits into Enter ISBN, or tap the barcode icon to use the camera.
3. Fill in the Title — it is the only required field.
4. Add authors and subjects by tapping Add author and Add subject as many times as you need.
5. Under Where the copy is, write where the book actually is: Shelf 3, Box in the attic, Lent to John.
6. To photograph the cover, tap Photograph the cover.
7. Tap Save. The button only becomes active once there is a title.


19:03
Cancel
New book
Save
Look up by ISBN
Enter ISBN
Cover photo
Photograph the cover
Book details
Title
Year of publication
Where the copy is
Country
— no country —

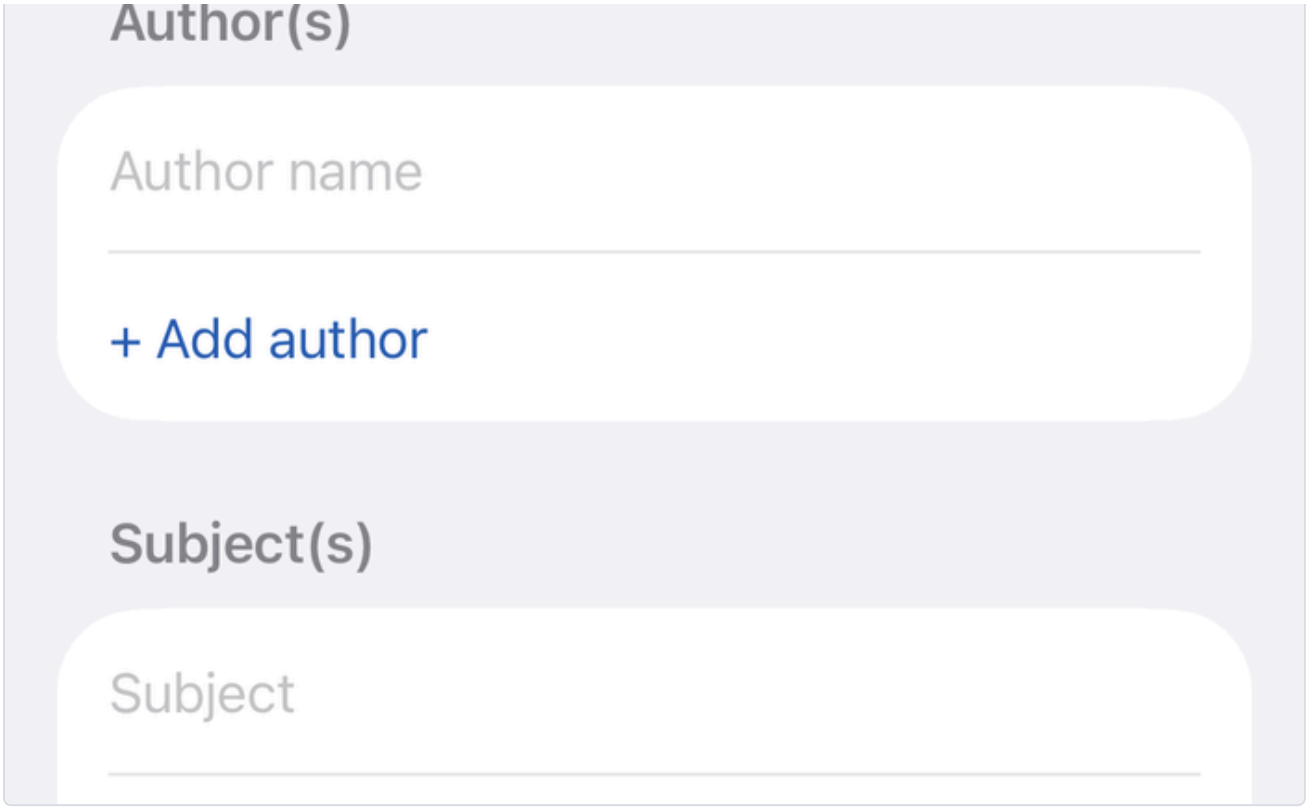
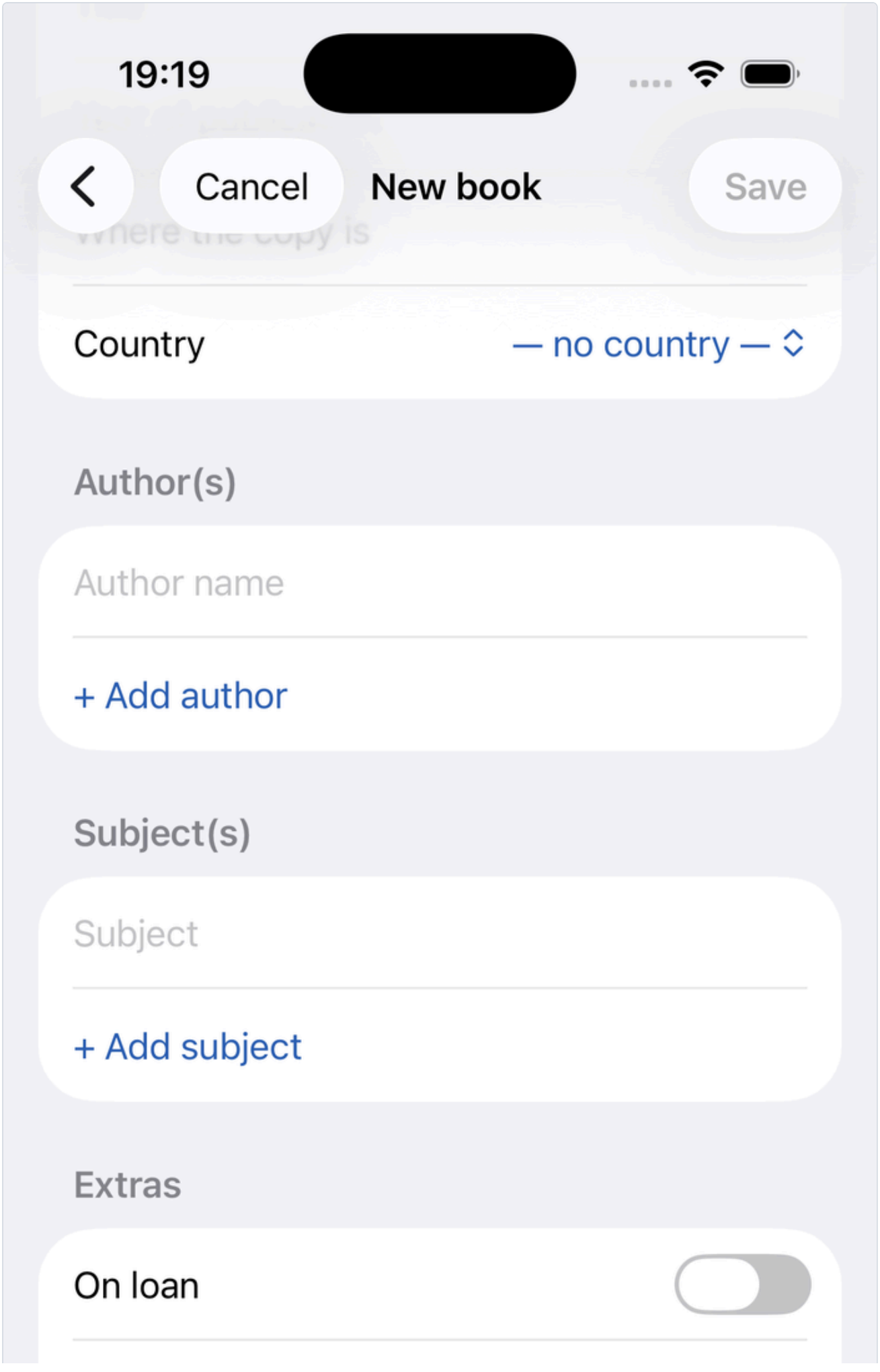


Figure 3: The New book screen: look up by ISBN, cover photo and the book details.


19:19
Cancel
New book
Save
Country
— no country —
Author(s)
Author name
+ Add author
Subject(s)
Subject
+ Add subject
Extras
On loan

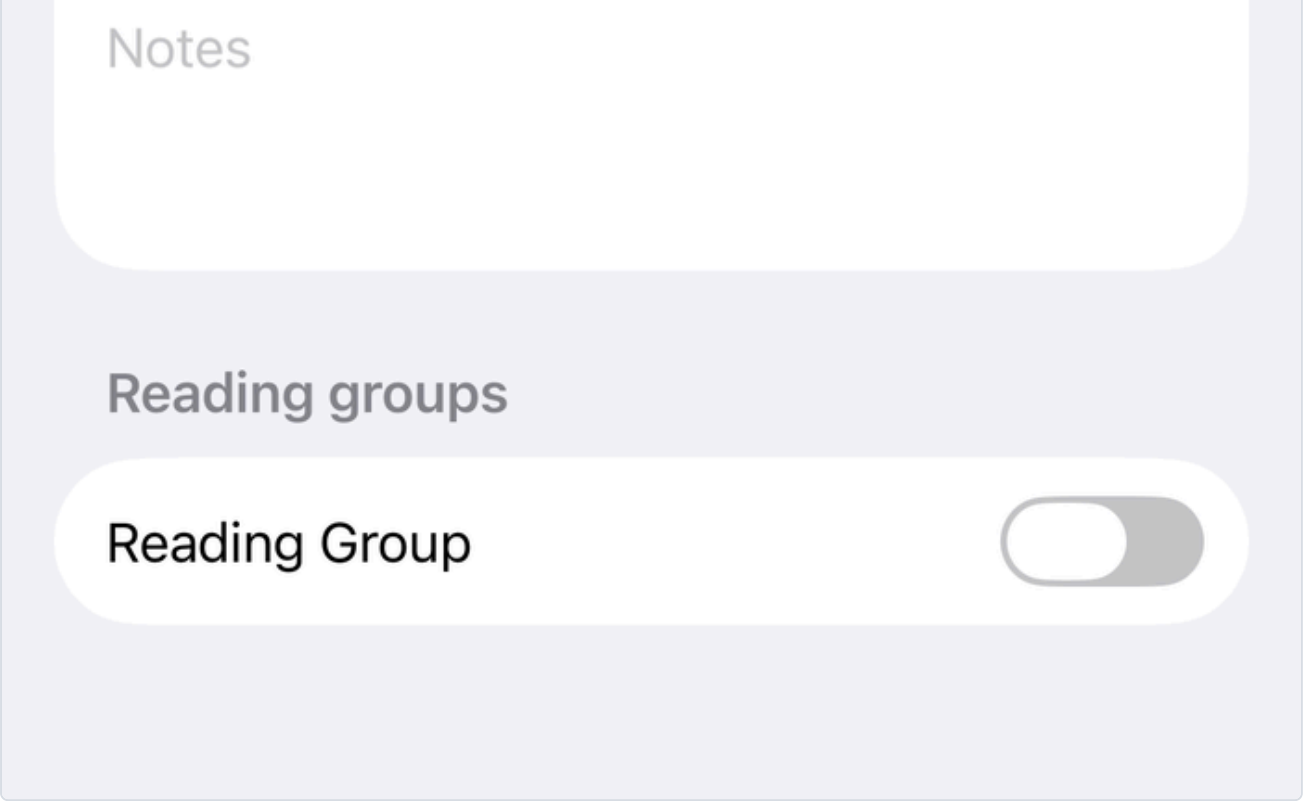


Figure 4: The rest of the same screen: authors, subjects, extras and reading groups.

Examples

- A book with two authors: tap Add author once and fill in both lines.
- A book on loan: turn on the On loan switch and write the name under Notes.
- A reading-group book: turn on the Reading Group switch — it then shows up in the groups filter.

Searching and filtering

The Search screen is where you find a book and, from there, reach everything else.

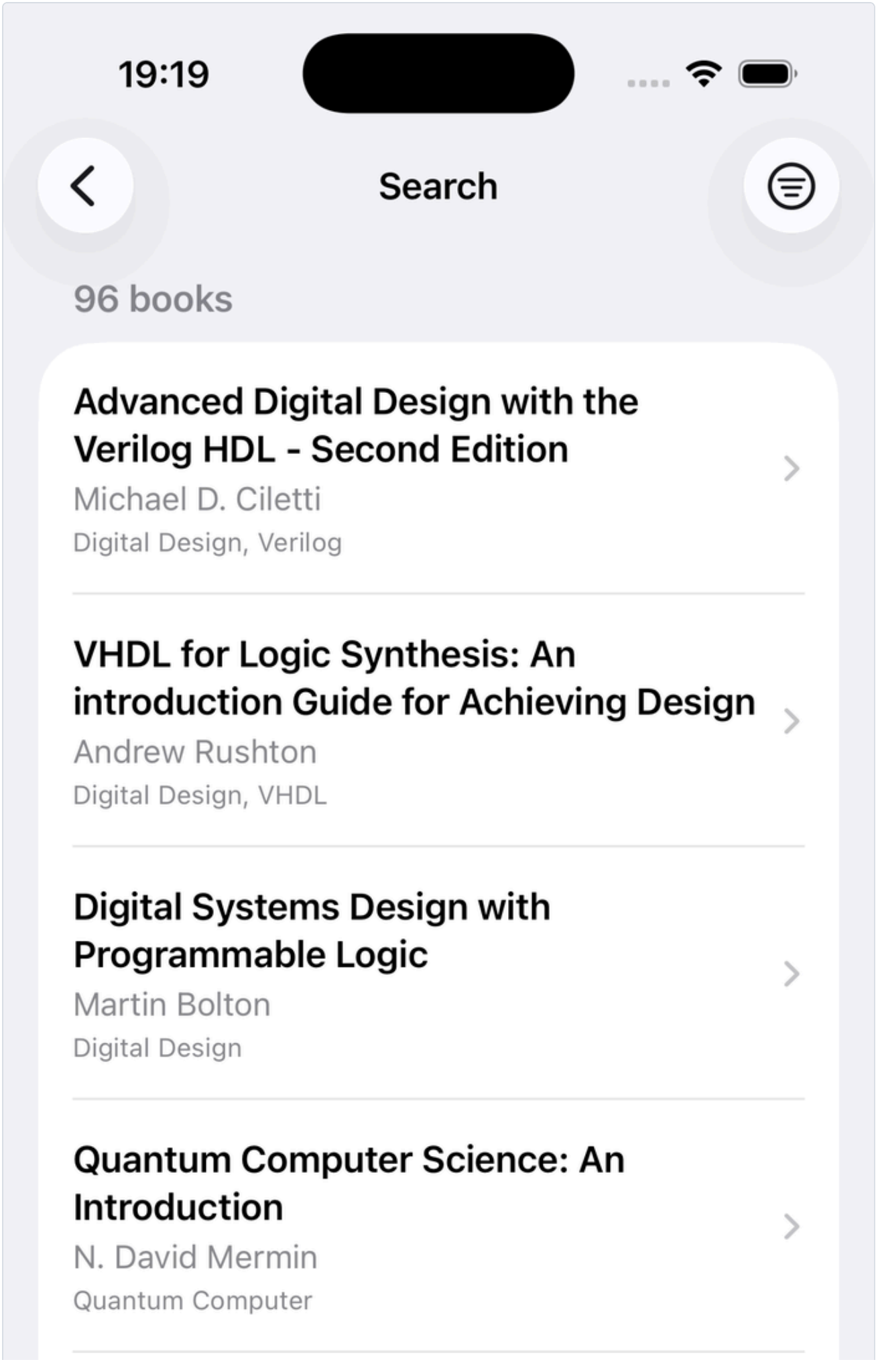
The search field sits at the bottom of the screen, within thumb's reach. It searches title, author, subject and where the copy is all at once — you do not have to say which field to look in.

At the top, the count says how many books the search found; with nothing typed, it shows the whole catalogue. In the top right corner, the filters button opens the cuts by subject, author, country, on-loan and reading groups.

Each row carries the title, the authors just below and the subjects in grey — enough to recognise the book without opening it.

Step by step

1. On the home screen, tap Search.
2. Type any part of what you remember: part of the title, the author's surname, a subject.
3. The list narrows as you type; the count at the top follows along.
4. For finer cuts, tap the filters button in the top right corner.
5. Tap a book to open its record.


19:19
Search
96 books
Advanced Digital Design with the Verilog HDL - Second Edition
Michael D. Ciletti
Digital Design, Verilog
VHDL for Logic Synthesis: An introduction Guide for Achieving Design
Andrew Rushton
Digital Design, VHDL
Digital Systems Design with Programmable Logic
Martin Bolton
Digital Design
Quantum Computer Science: An Introduction
N. David Mermin
Quantum Computer

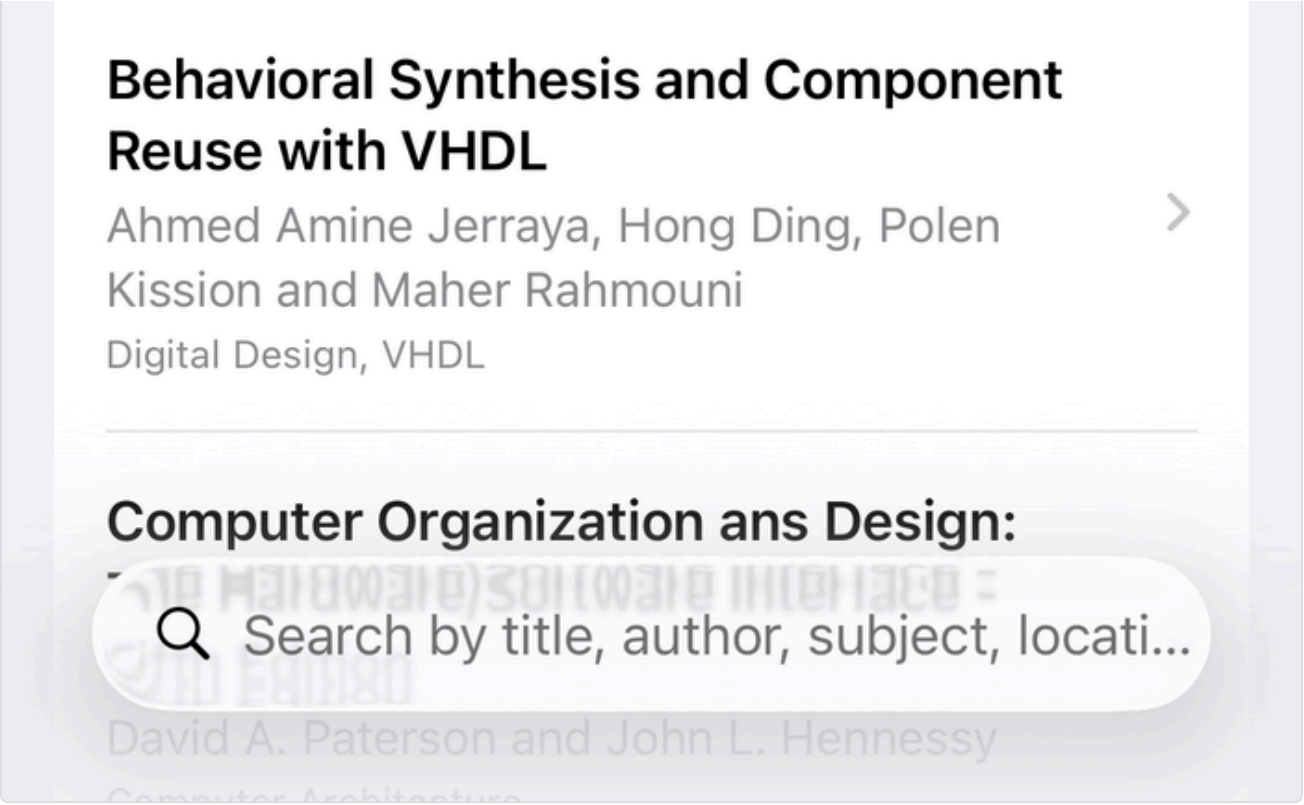


Figure 5: Search, with the count at the top and the search field at the bottom of the screen.

Examples

- Searching for VHDL finds both the books with VHDL in the title and those with VHDL as a subject.
- Searching for Shelf 3 lists everything on that shelf — the search looks at where the copy is too.

The book record

The record shows everything the catalogue knows about that book, in sections: the cover at the top, then Identification (title and year), Author(s), Subject(s) and Status.

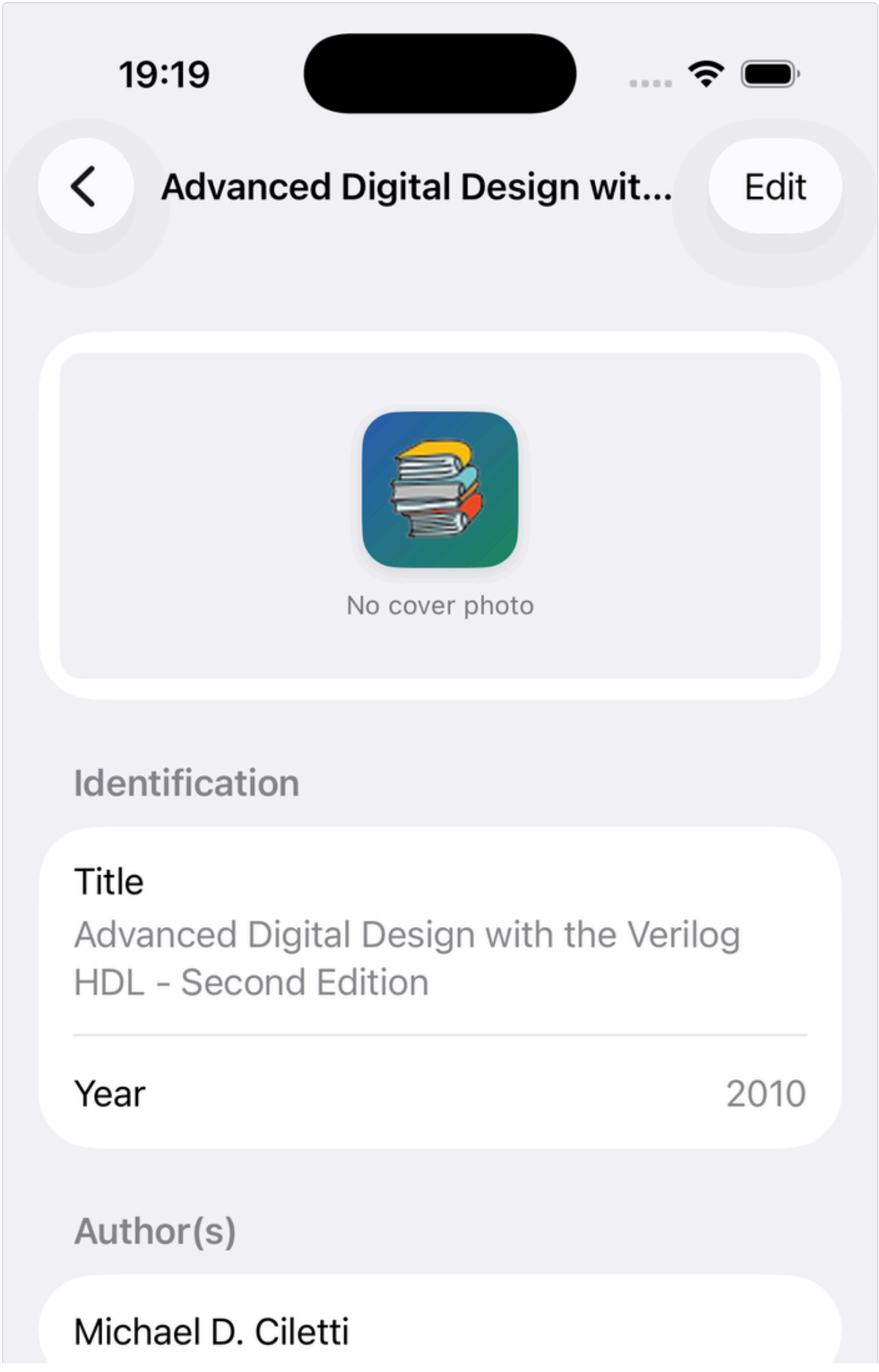
Empty sections do not appear: a book with no subjects simply has no Subject(s) section, rather than showing an empty one.

The Edit button, in the top right corner, opens the same form as adding a book, already filled in — that is where you correct anything, including deleting the book.

Step by step

1. In search, tap the book.

2. Scroll the record from top to bottom to see cover, identification, authors, subjects and status.
3. Tap Edit to change any field.
4. To go back to the list, tap the arrow in the top left corner.


19:19
Advanced Digital Design wit...
Edit
No cover photo
Identification
Title
Advanced Digital Design with the Verilog HDL - Second Edition
Year
2010
Author(s)
Michael D. Ciletti

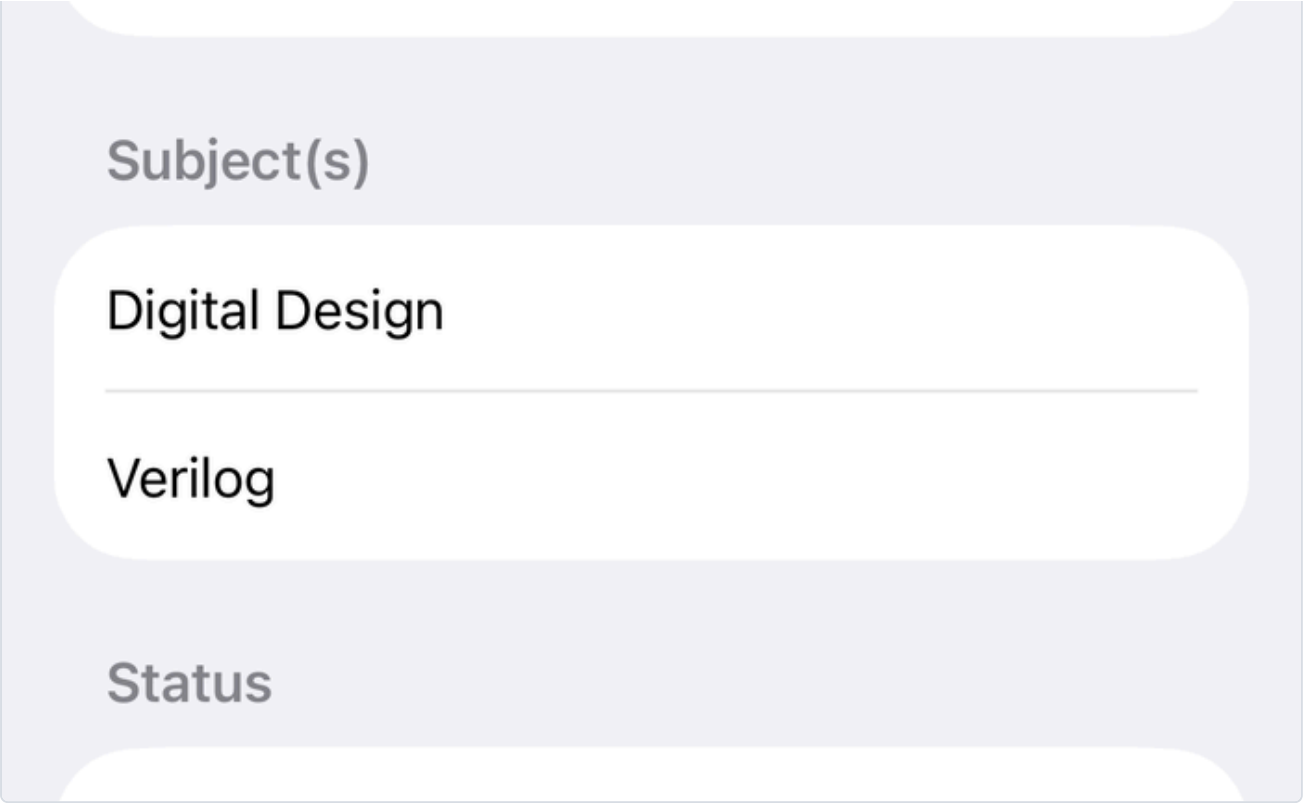


Figure 6: A book's record, with the cover, the identification, the authors and the subjects.

Countries

This screen answers one question: where your books come from.

Each country appears with its count and a proportional bar, from the most numerous to the least. At the foot, the summary — how many books from how many countries.

Tapping a country takes you to its list of books.

The country is not typed in book by book in most cases: it comes from the ISBN, which carries the publisher's region. That is why a catalogue you have just started may show this screen empty, with a note explaining that the country comes from the subject or the ISBN.

Step by step

1. On the home screen, tap Countries.
2. Read the list from the top down: it comes sorted by count.
3. Tap a country to see which books are from it.


19:21
Countries
United States 29
Brazil 19
United Kingdom 19
France 10
Germany 10
Netherlands 9
96 books from 6 countries

Figure 7: The Countries screen: how many books came from each place.

Sync

This is the screen that connects the iPhone to everything else. It has two halves.

At the top, the state: which file is selected, how many books came from it, when it was last reloaded and whether iCloud Drive is answering.

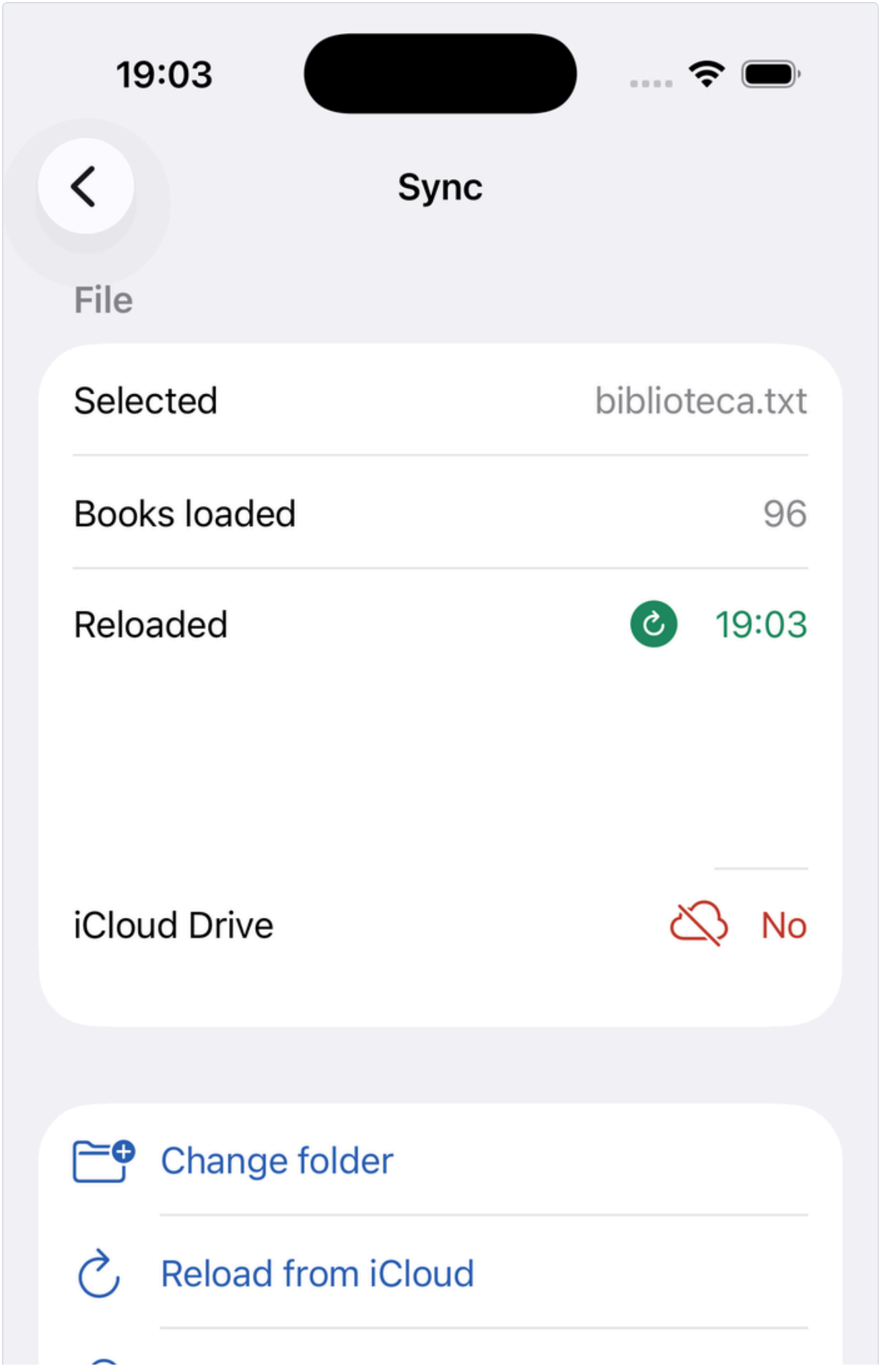
Below, the three actions. Change folder picks the iCloud folder again — it is the installation step. Reload from iCloud reads the file again, for when you changed the catalogue on the Mac and want the change here. Write to iCloud does the opposite: it pushes what is on the iPhone out to the file.

Further down, the app itself repeats the step by step of syncing with the Mac — handy when you install it on a new iPhone and do not have this manual at hand.

Step by step

1. On the home screen, tap Sync.
2. Check that Selected shows biblioteca.txt and that Books loaded shows a number greater than zero.
3. After changing the catalogue on the Mac, tap Reload from iCloud.

4. If iCloud Drive shows as No, the device has no cloud: check the connection and whether iCloud Drive is on in Settings.


19:03
Sync
File
Selected
biblioteca.txt
Books loaded
96
Reloaded
19:03
iCloud Drive
No
Change folder
Reload from iCloud

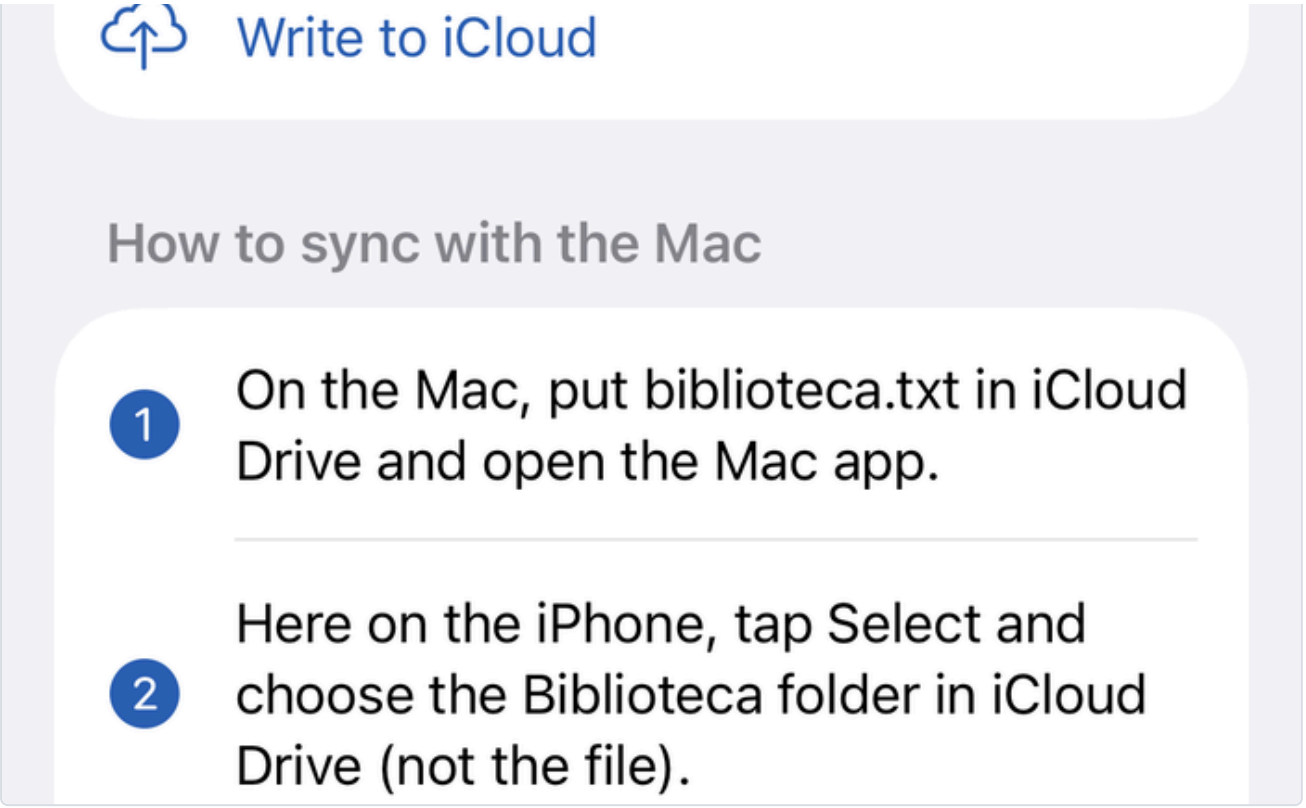


Figure 8: The Sync screen: which file, how many books and the three actions.

Examples

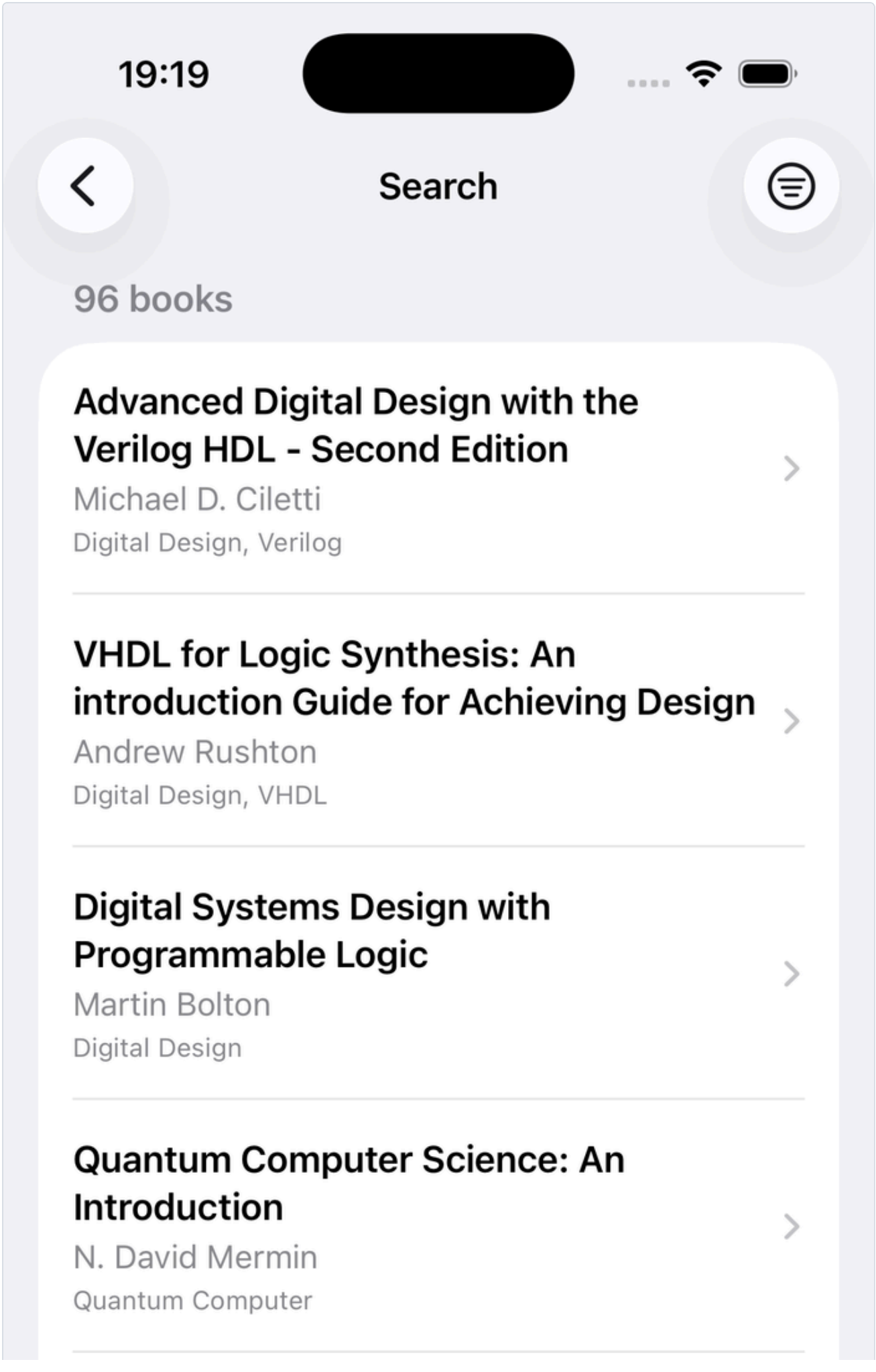
- Added a book on the iPhone and want it on the Mac: tap Write to iCloud and open the Mac app.
- Added a book on the Mac and want it on the iPhone: tap Reload from iCloud.

From nothing to finding your first book

This walkthrough strings together what the sections above showed separately: install, connect to the catalogue, add a book with the camera, find it in search and watch the change reach the Mac. It takes about ten minutes.

1. Install the app from the App Store and open it.
2. Tap "Choose folder" and pick the Biblioteca folder in iCloud Drive.
3. Go back to the home screen and check the count of books loaded.
4. If the app opened in English and you prefer Portuguese, tap the PT/EN globe.
5. Pick up a paper book, tap Scan a book and point the camera at the barcode on the back cover.

6. Check what the lookup brought back, write under Where the copy is where the book lives, and tap Save.
7. Tap Search and type part of the title: the new book must show up.
8. Tap it to open the record and confirm the authors and subjects.
9. Go back to Sync and tap Write to iCloud.
10. Open the Mac app: the book you have just scanned is there.


19:19
Search
96 books
Advanced Digital Design with the Verilog HDL - Second Edition
Michael D. Ciletti
Digital Design, Verilog
VHDL for Logic Synthesis: An introduction Guide for Achieving Design
Andrew Rushton
Digital Design, VHDL
Digital Systems Design with Programmable Logic
Martin Bolton
Digital Design
Quantum Computer Science: An Introduction
N. David Mermin
Quantum Computer

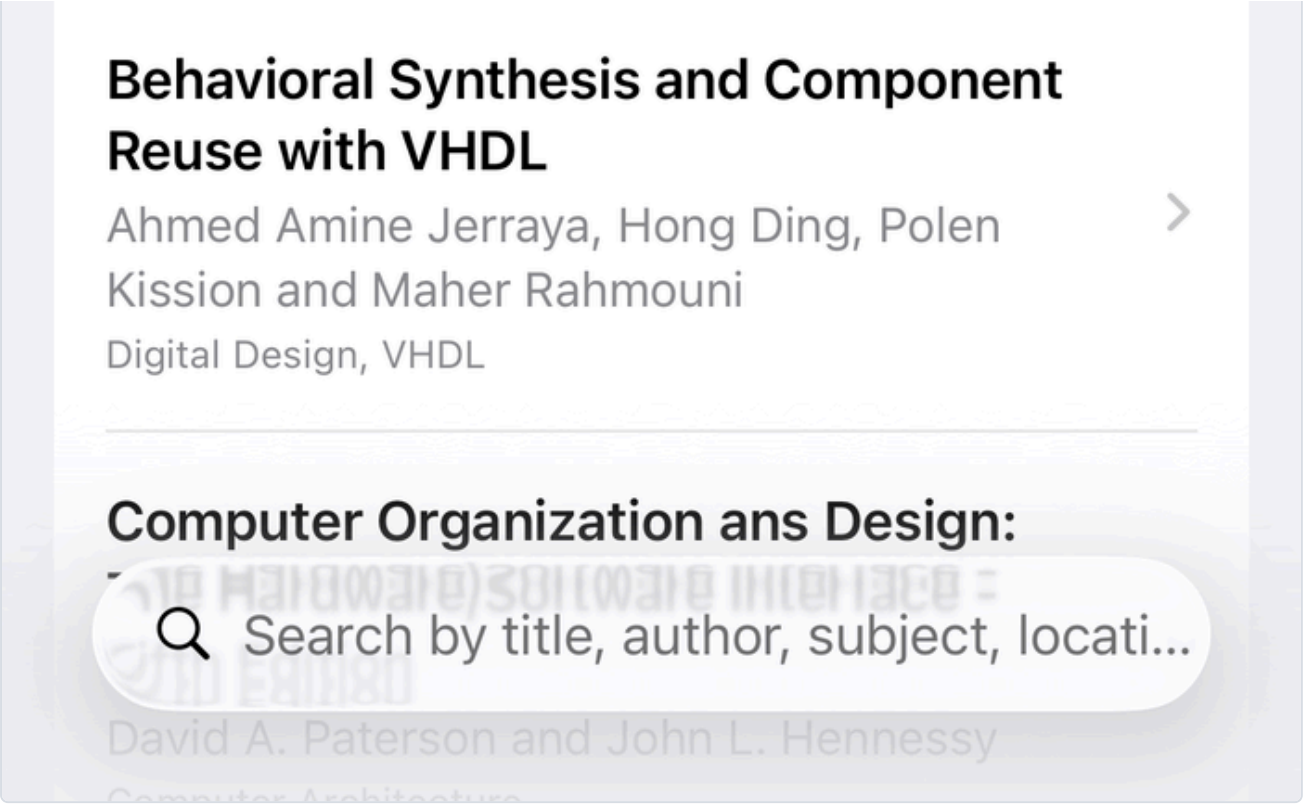


Figure 9: The end of the walkthrough: the new book found in search.

Troubleshooting

I installed the app and I do not know how to create my biblioteca.txt.

You do not need to create it elsewhere. Go to Sync, choose the folder where it should live — it can be empty — and add a book. The file is created in that folder, with the book in it.

I do not have a biblioteca.dat. What am I missing?

Nothing. It is the file of covers and only appears once covers have been published, by this app or by the Mac one. Without it the app works just the same.

The home screen shows zero books, or no count at all.

The folder was not linked. On the home screen, tap "Choose folder" and pick the Biblioteca folder — stop AT the folder, do not go inside it to select the file.

I added a book on the Mac and the iPhone still shows the old catalogue.

The iPhone does not reread the file constantly. Go to Sync and tap Reload from iCloud.

I added a book on the iPhone and the Mac does not see it.

Tap Write to iCloud, on the Sync screen, and wait for iCloud to finish uploading before opening the Mac app.

The camera does not open when I tap Scan a book.

Camera permission was refused. Open the iPhone Settings, find Biblioteca in the list of apps and turn Camera on.

I scanned the barcode and the app did not find the book.

Not every ISBN is in the databases consulted, especially for older books or small publishers. Tap Add a book and type the details by hand — the book goes in just the same.

iCloud Drive shows as No on the Sync screen.

The device has no access to the cloud. Check the connection, and in Settings check that you are signed in to iCloud and that iCloud Drive is on.

The app opened in English without my asking.

The first time, the app follows the iPhone's language: Portuguese only if the device is in Portuguese. Tap the PT/EN globe to change it; the choice is remembered.

The App Store is still offering the previous version.

Every version goes through Apple's review before reaching the store. It can take a few days, and there is nothing to do but wait.

Glossary

biblioteca.txt

The file where the catalogue lives. Plain text, one book per line, fields separated by tabs. It is the same file on all four platforms.

ISBN

The 10- or 13-digit number that identifies an edition. It is what the barcode on the back cover carries, and what the app uses to look the book up.

Where the copy is

Where your book physically is — the shelf, the box, the house of whoever borrowed it. Search looks in this field too.

Reading group

A mark for books discussed in a group. It works as a filter in search.

Sync

Making the file and the device agree. Reload brings from iCloud to the iPhone; Write sends from the iPhone to iCloud.

TestFlight

Apple's app through which testers receive versions before the store. If you install from the App Store you do not need it.

References

- The app's page: https://wruggiero.github.io/Biblioteca/
- Biblioteca Pessoal on the App Store: https://apps.apple.com/app/biblioteca-pessoal/id6799312712
- Manuals for the other platforms (Mac, Windows and Android) on the same page.